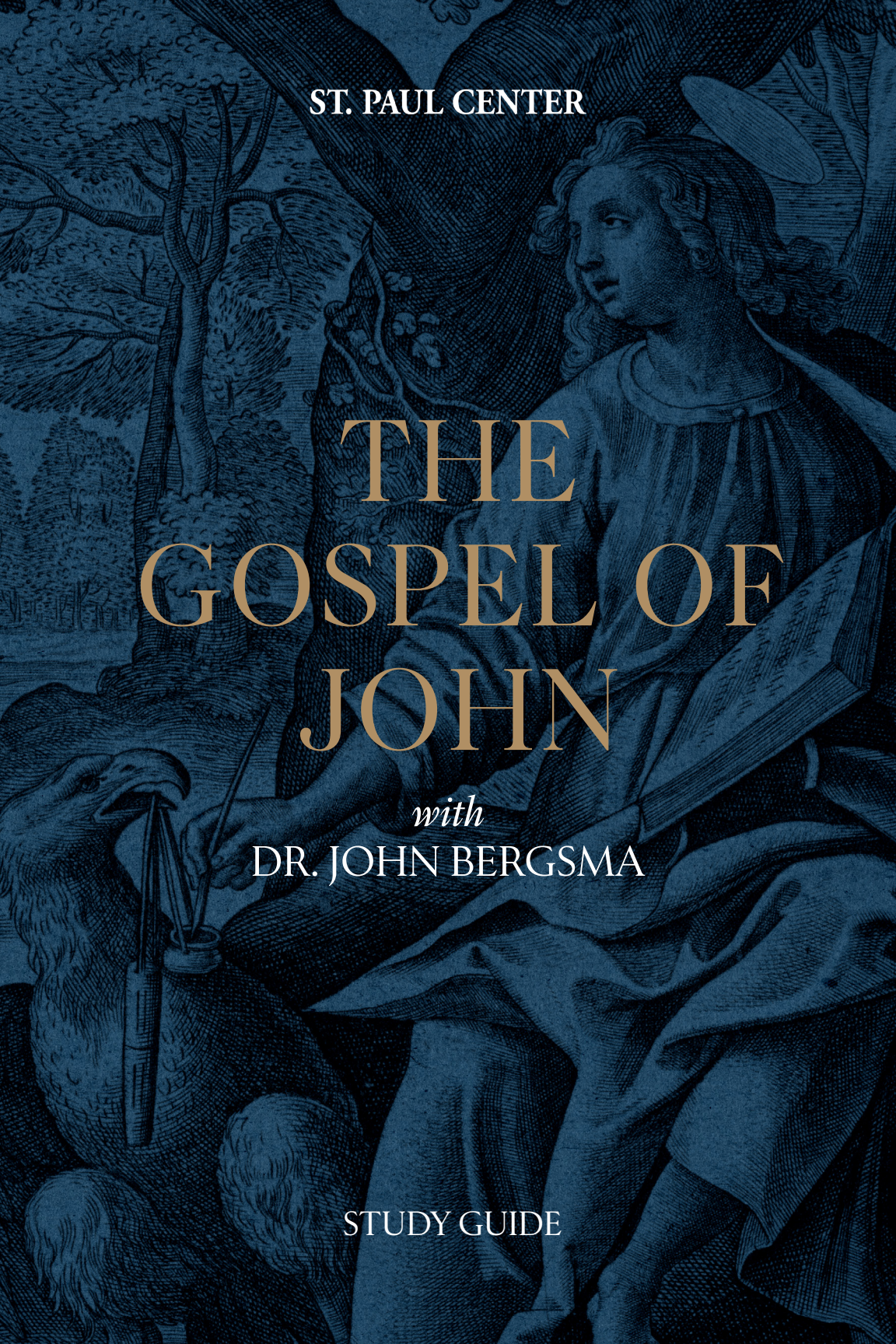




ST. PAUL CENTER

THE GOSPEL OF JOHN

with
DR. JOHN BERGSMA

STUDY GUIDE



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TABLE *of* CONTENTS

Introduction & Using This Study Guide	4
Studying in Community & Practical Discussion Tips	5
EPISODE 1	
Authorship, Structure, & Style	8
EPISODE 2	
Seven Signs, Seven Sacraments	12
EPISODE 3	
Jesus Christ, Divine Bridegroom	16
EPISODE 4	
For the Life of the World	20
EPISODE 5	
The Resurrection & The Life	24
EPISODE 6	
New Priesthood & New Covenant	28
EPISODE 7	
The Cross: Marriage Bed of the Messiah	32
EPISODE 8	
The Resurrection: My Lord and My God!	36
Review Questions Answer Key	40
Next Steps	41

INTRODUCTION

The Gospel of John is perhaps the greatest book ever written, as striking to readers today as it was two thousand years ago. Regardless of background, education, or age, when a person picks up this gospel, St. John brings them face to face with the Word made flesh. In this course from the St. Paul Center, Dr. John Bergsma invites you to encounter Jesus Christ in a powerful new way through the pages of John's Gospel.

The Apostle John proclaims the Good News of salvation history like no other, weaving together a tapestry of themes, signs, and stories. Join Dr. Bergsma as he explores the rich sacramental connections between Jesus' miracles and the powerful ways in which the Holy Spirit is continuing to work in the life of the Church today.

In this course, you will encounter Christ the Divine Bridegroom who laid His life down for His Bride, the Church. He is truly the resurrection and the life of the world, all things to all men, everything we need.

ABOUT DR. JOHN BERGSMA

Dr. John Bergsma is Vice President for Biblical Theology and Mission Effectiveness at the St. Paul Center for Biblical Theology and Professor of Theology at the Franciscan University of Steubenville, where he has taught Scripture since 2004. He holds B.A., M.Div. and Th.M. degrees from Calvin College and Seminary (now Calvin University) and a Ph.D. in Biblical Studies from the University of Notre Dame (Indiana).

A former Protestant pastor, Dr. Bergsma has authored numerous books on Scripture and the Catholic Faith, including *Jesus and the Jubilee: The Biblical Roots of the Year of God's Favor* and *The Word of the Lord: Reflections on the Sunday Mass Readings* series. He has also published over two dozen peer-reviewed essays and articles in various scholarly journals, dictionaries, encyclopedias, and essay collections. Dr. Bergsma speaks regularly for parish missions, diocesan conferences, clergy convocations, and other events nationally and internationally.

USING *this* STYLE GUIDE

This study guide is a streamlined, accessible resource designed to help you get the most out of this course. Each episode is accompanied by its own resources to help foster your understanding of the material.

You can expect:

- ✿ Brief descriptions of each episode. Read this before you watch the episode.
- ✿ Content outlines with notetaking space to follow along as you watch the episode.
- ✿ Two multiple-choice questions to help you review the episode.
- ✿ Three open-ended questions for group discussion and personal reflection.
- ✿ Practical challenges to help you bring what you learned in each episode into the rest of your week.
- ✿ A quick look ahead at the next episode's topics.

STUDYING *in* COMMUNITY

Although you can certainly complete this course on the Gospel of John on your own, we have designed this study guide with a group setting in mind. Jesus teaches that “where two or three are gathered together in [His] name,” He is present in their midst (Mt 18:19). As brothers and sisters in Christ, when we come together in community to pray and enter into God’s word, the Holy Spirit is able to transform the hearts of all present in a unique, powerful way. Whether you are going through this course with your spouse, your friends, or in another setting like a parish Bible study, this is an opportunity to accompany one another in the spiritual life and grow closer to the Lord.

Set aside distractions, like your phone and social media, and intentionally commit to this being a time of encounter and conversation. Share your faith and listen to the ways, both big and small, that the Lord is working. In this course, as you study God’s word, invite the Holy Spirit to transform you in love and empower you to share the Good News of Jesus Christ with the world.

PRACTICAL DISCUSSION TIPS

Respect the privacy of the group.

Over the course of your discussions, people may feel called to share their own personal stories or experiences with the group. As brothers and sisters in Christ, it is important to respect one another's privacy. Encourage a safe environment where everyone can grow in holiness.

Invite others into the conversation.

As your group reflects on each episode using the resources in this study guide, pay attention to the conversation dynamics. Are two or three people doing all the talking? Are you dominating the conversation? Do you notice someone not speaking at all?

Practice active listening, not judgement.

Remember, each person is on their own personal journey with the Lord. As you enter into this time of study, ask the Lord to grant you an increase in charity toward your brothers and sisters in Christ.

It's okay to not have all the answers.

Asking questions is an important part of growing in relationship with the Lord. Don't be afraid to admit if you're confused about something. As a group, when you come across difficulties, consult resources like the *Catechism of the Catholic Church* and the *Ignatius Catholic Study Bible*, or reach out to priests and catechists in your parish with your questions.

EPISODE 1

AUTHORSHIP, STRUCTURE, & STYLE

Description

In this first episode, Dr. Bergsma lays the groundwork for this course. He begins with an apologetics-style defense of Johannine authorship of the Gospel, demonstrating how all the available evidence supports the Church's historically held position. Dr. Bergsma also explains why the Apostle John wrote his Gospel to complement the Synoptic Gospels of Matthew, Mark, and Luke. Following analysis, Dr. Bergsma digs into the literary structure and composition of John's Gospel, paying special attention to the seven miraculous "signs," and the Gospel's unique style.

Outline

- ✿ Johannine Authorship: internal and external evidence
- ✿ Written in the late first century
- ✿ John records seven works (signs) of Jesus, pointing to the Seven Sacraments
- ✿ John assumes his readers know the Synoptic Gospels
- ✿ Literary irony and polyvalence

My Notes

Review Questions

1. True or False: The Book of Revelation was written prior to the Gospel of John.
 - a. True
 - b. False
2. Which of the following is NOT one of the seven signs?
 - a. Jesus' Passion & Resurrection
 - b. The Descent of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost
 - c. The Feeding of the Five Thousand
 - d. The Healing of the Man Born Blind



Reflection Questions

- 1. As Dr. Bergsma said, the Gospel of John sounds much different than Matthew, Mark, and Luke. Have you noticed this before? Why or why not?
- 2. Did any of the evidence Dr. Bergsma presented in support of traditional Johannine authorship surprise you? Why do you think that might be?
- 3. Why do you think John chose to refer to himself as the “Beloved Disciple” rather than using a pseudonym?

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Practical Application

This week, choose a chapter from the Gospel of John to read and reflect on. What aspects of John’s literary style and theological focus stand out to you? Did you notice anything new?

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Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma explores the relationship between the signs that Jesus performs in the Gospel of John and the sacraments of the Catholic Church.

EPISODE 2

SEVEN SIGNS, SEVEN SACRAMENTS

Description

In the first half of this episode, Dr. Bergsma explains the connection between Our Lord's "signs of power" in the Gospel of John and the Seven Sacraments of the Catholic Church. Reading John in light of the sacraments has the power to transform the way we experience and share the Good News of salvation history. In the second half of this episode, Dr. Bergsma examines John 1 and 2, investigating how Our Lord fulfills the promises of Scripture. The three key themes Bergsma discusses are a new creation, a new Adam, and the eschatological bridegroom.

Outline

- ✿ Connecting the signs in John's Gospel with the sacraments
- ✿ A new creation, a new Adam, and the ultimate Bridegroom
- ✿ Themes of light & darkness; John the Baptist witnessed to the light
- ✿ The body of Christ = the new Temple
- ✿ The Wedding at Cana & the "hour" of Jesus' death
- ✿ Mary = the new Eve
- ✿ Mary teaches us how to pray
- ✿ The good wine = Eucharist
- ✿ Cleansing of the Temple

3. True or False: Jesus is the new Isaac and the new Moses.
 - a. True
 - b. False
4. True or False: The Prologue of John's Gospel is closely tied to the theme of creation found in the opening chapter of Exodus.
 - a. True
 - b. False



Reflection Questions

- 1. Can you name all seven “signs” in John’s Gospel? What sacrament(s) do you think each one points to?
- 2. The Prologue of John states that “the darkness has not overcome [the light]” (John 1:5). What do you think John means by this? What might he be trying to tell us about Jesus’ life and ministry as a whole?
- 3. In John 2:21, why does Jesus speak of “the temple of his body”? By using this phrase, what is He revealing about His identity?

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Practical Application

Reread the account of the Wedding at Cana (John 2:1–12). In light of your own prayer life, consider the exchanges that take place between Our Lady, Jesus, and the servants. Be honest; when you are in need, do you turn to God, or something else? When you pray, do you find yourself constantly trying to problem-solve on God’s behalf? As you read through this passage, pay close attention to Mary’s humility, the swift obedience of the servants, and the trust that the steward puts in Jesus. Write down two or three practical ways you could apply what you see to your own relationship with the Lord. As you go about your week, return to your list and reflect on what you wrote.

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Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma shares powerful truths about Jesus’ love for us and explores Our Lord’s messianic role as the Divine Bridegroom of Israel.

EPISODE 3

JESUS CHRIST, DIVINE BRIDEGROOM

Description

In this episode, Dr. Bergsma discusses John 3–5, focusing on the image of Our Lord as Divine Bridegroom of Israel. He begins by examining the figures of Nicodemus and John the Baptist, who both appear in John 3. Through Our Lord’s conversation with Nicodemus, it becomes clear that, out of love for us, Jesus came to free us from sin and darkness. This is a powerful truth intimately connected with our baptism. Dr. Bergsma walks through Jesus’ encounter with the Samaritan woman, who, despite appearances, longs for the coming Messiah. Finally, Dr. Bergsma concludes this episode by discussing two of the “signs” performed by Our Lord: the healing of the official’s son, and the healing of the paralytic.

Outline

- ✿ Nicodemus asks Jesus about being “born again”, foreshadowing baptism
- ✿ John the Baptist identifies Jesus as the Bridegroom
- ✿ Jesus meets the Samaritan woman at Jacob’s well. He reveals Himself as the Messiah & Bridegroom of Israel
- ✿ Healing the official’s son: Anointing of the Sick
- ✿ Healing the paralytic: Sacrament of Reconciliation

My Notes

Review Questions

1. In John 3:1-2, Nicodemus comes to Jesus by night. What does this action symbolize?
 - a. A lack of knowledge
 - b. The light of the Holy Spirit
 - c. Spiritual darkness
 - d. Both A & C
2. True or False: The Samaritan woman's adultery is symbolic of the idolatrous history of the Northern tribes.
 - a. True
 - b. False



Reflection Questions

1. Every year on the Third Sunday in Lent, the Church invites the faithful to reflect on the story of the woman at the well. In light of what Dr. Bergsma shared in this episode, why do you think the Church returns to this passage year after year? What aspects of the Samaritan woman's story reflect the themes of the Lenten season?
 2. What are your thoughts on the connection between the "living water" Jesus offers the Samaritan woman and the description of Solomon's bride as a "well of living water" in Song of Songs 4:15?
 3. Dr. Bergsma described the man Jesus healed in John 5 as an "icon of the people of Israel." When you examine this passage, what dimensions of the paralyzed man's story reflect the history of the Israelites in the Old Testament? What aspects of the man's encounter with Our Lord can offer insight into the Christian life today?
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Practical Application

This week, try doing lectio divina prayer with the story of the Samaritan woman (John 4:1–41). Ask the Holy Spirit to help you listen to God's voice. Read slowly through the passage as many times as you need. When you encounter a word or phrase that stands out to you, pause and meditate on it. Enter into loving conversation with the Lord. Talk to Him openly and honestly about what you notice coming up in your heart as you reflect on this story.

Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma examines the famous Bread of Life Discourse. He shares how themes of light and water point toward Our Lord's self-gift on Calvary for the life of the world.

EPISODE 4

FOR THE LIFE OF THE WORLD

Description

Dr. Bergsma begins this episode by examining the feeding of the 5000 and the Bread of Life Discourse in John 6. Jesus is the new fruit of the Tree of Life. He states that the man who chews His Body and drinks His Blood will live forever. Early Christians would have easily drawn the connection between Jesus' Real Presence in the Eucharist and what Jesus teaches in John 6. In the next part of this episode, Dr. Bergsma demonstrates how the actions and teachings of Our Lord in John 7–10 connect to the ancient Jewish Feast of Tabernacles. He focuses especially on themes of water, light, and temple-building. On the cross, Jesus fulfilled Ezekiel's prophetic vision of water flowing from the side of the Temple: from Jesus' pierced side poured forth blood and water for the life of the world. In the final section of this episode, Dr. Bergsma unpacks Jesus's encounter with the woman caught in adultery, His healing of the man born blind, concluding the episode with a brief analysis of the Good Shepherd Discourse.

Outline

- ✿ Feeding of the 5000 & connections to Eucharistic institution narratives
- ✿ Bread of Life Discourse; "...chews my flesh and drinks my blood..."
- ✿ The Feast of Tabernacles: Light and water rituals connected to prophecies about the Temple
- ✿ Jesus: living water, light of the world
- ✿ The woman caught in adultery
- ✿ Jesus heals the man born blind
- ✿ Good Shepherd Discourse during the Feast of Dedication

1. True or False: In the Bread of Life Discourse, Jesus identifies Himself as the new fruit of the Tree of Life.
 - a. True
 - b. False
2. On the last day of the Feast of Tabernacles, Jesus stood up in the temple and said, “If any one thirst, let him come to me and drink” (John 7:37). What Old Testament passage points to Jesus’ words here?
 - a. Ezekiel’s vision of life-giving water coming from the Temple (Ezek 47:1–12)
 - b. Zechariah’s description of Jerusalem as a spring of living water (Zech 14:8)
 - c. The Lord bringing forth water from the rock in the wilderness (Num 20:10–13)
 - d. All of the above



Reflection Questions

1. In John 6:54, 56, 57, and 58, Jesus uses the Greek verb *trōgō*, to describe the action of “eating” his flesh. Though *trōgō* is rendered “eat” in English, verbs like “chew,” “munch,” or “gnaw” are more precise. When you consider the Eucharist in light of these words, what comes to mind? Why was this a “hard saying” for Jesus’ disciples in John 6:60? Why is it a “hard saying” to accept today?
 2. Take a look at Ezekiel’s vision of life-giving water flowing from the Temple in Ezekiel 47:1–12. What parallels can you draw from the prophet’s vision to Our Lord’s ministry? To His Passion? How does Ezekiel’s vision connect to the workings of the Holy Spirit in the life of the early Church?
 3. At the Temple, when Jesus encounters the woman caught in adultery, He writes with His finger on the ground. Why do you think He chose to do this? What might His actions evoke or symbolize? What do you think he wrote?
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Practical Application

As Catholics, we make the Sign of the Cross so often that it can become a motion we go through without thinking twice. But when we slow down, we realize that the Sign of the Cross is a radical, powerful act that recalls the spiritual death and resurrection that took place at our baptism. Like the man Jesus heals in John 9, baptism opens our spiritual eyes to Christ. This week, as you make the Sign of the Cross in your prayers, ask the Lord for greater spiritual awareness. As much as you can, try to consciously pray through this action each time you do it.

Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma delves into Jesus’ self-revelation as “the resurrection and the life” and examines His messianic role as the Son of David.

EPISODE 5

THE RESURRECTION & THE LIFE

Description

In this episode, Dr. Bergsma walks through the key events of John 11 and 12, beginning with the sixth “sign” recorded by John, the raising of Lazarus. This sign is closely connected to the Sacrament of Confirmation, wherein disciples of Christ are strengthened by the Holy Spirit to bear witness to the Lord—even in the face of death. The raising of Lazarus also confirms Martha’s confession: Jesus is the Messiah, the one whom the Father sent into the world. In revealing Himself to Martha as “the resurrection and the life,” Jesus also fulfills Ezekiel’s vision of the dry bones. Following this powerful analysis, Dr. Bergsma turns his attention to the anointing at Bethany which takes place in John 12. Not only does this event mark Jesus as the Son of David and the true bridegroom of the Song of Songs, but it is an action of preparation for His death. Fittingly, Dr. Bergsma concludes this episode by recounting Our Lord’s triumphal entry into Jerusalem at the start of Passion Week.

Outline

- ✿ Jesus hears of Lazarus’s illness but delays coming
- ✿ Lazarus is dead when Jesus arrives
- ✿ Jesus meets Martha, reveals Himself as the “resurrection and the life”
- ✿ Martha confesses Jesus as the Christ
- ✿ Raising of Lazarus = a sign of the Sacrament of Confirmation and a revelation of Jesus’ divinity
- ✿ Mary of Bethany anoints Jesus, marking Him as the Son of David
- ✿ Jesus’ triumphal entry into Jerusalem

1. Jesus knew Lazarus would die, but He still waited two extra days before traveling to Bethany. What reason does Jesus give for this delay?
 - a. He was afraid of the Judeans because they were seeking to stone Him
 - b. Death would not be Lazarus's ultimate fate, and his resurrection would glorify God
 - c. Jesus was unsure if He had the power to heal Lazarus
2. What is the perfume Mary uses to anoint Jesus in John 12:3?
 - a. Myrrh
 - b. Frankincense
 - c. Nard



Reflection Questions

1. “Jesus wept,” is one of the most profound verses in all of scripture (John 11:35). When you picture Our Lord weeping outside the tomb of His friend, what comes to mind? What does Jesus’ grief reveal about the nature of death? What does it reveal to us about His humanity?
 2. Reread Martha’s confession of faith that Jesus is the Christ (John 11:27). Does any particular aspect of her words stand out to you? Why? What might Martha be able to teach us about faith in God’s love?
 3. Nard is closely tied to nuptial themes in the Song of Songs (Song 1:12). However, in John 12:3–8, Jesus associates this highly evocative perfume with His coming death. What might this tell us about Jesus’ identity as Divine Bridegroom of the Church?
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Practical Application

After Jesus calls Lazarus from his tomb, He instructs the people standing near to unbind Lazarus’s hands and feet (John 11:44). The word “unbind” in this passage also has a spiritual sense, pointing to the “unbinding” from sin that takes place in the sacraments, particularly the Sacraments of Baptism and Reconciliation. Lord wants to offer you the gift of His life-changing, merciful love in the sacraments. If possible, set aside time to go to confession this week. As you prepare your heart and examine your conscience, meditate on the raising of Lazarus. Surrender your sins to the Lord. Ask Him to unbind the chains of sin and call you forth from your tomb into His own marvelous light.

Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma breaks down the structure and themes one of the most important sections of John’s Gospel: the Last Supper Discourse.

EPISODE 6

NEW PRIESTHOOD & NEW COVENANT

Description

In this episode, Dr. Bergsma explores the rich depths of John 13–17, a section of the Gospel traditionally known as the Last Supper Discourse. Unlike Matthew, Mark, and Luke, John chooses not to record the institution of the Eucharist. Instead, he recounts Jesus’ teachings on the night of the Last Supper. In chapter 13, Jesus prepares the Twelve for their future ministry as priests of the New Covenant by washing their feet. In chapters 14–16, He tells them about His coming death, resurrection, and ascension. Dr. Bergsma explains why Jesus chooses to emphasize the power of the Holy Spirit and how He will lead the Apostles into all truth. In the final part of this episode, Dr. Bergsma breaks down Jesus’ “High Priestly Prayer” in John 17, wherein Jesus prays for Himself, His disciples, and the Church.

Outline

- ✿ Jesus washes His disciples’s feet, preparing them for the priesthood of the New Covenant
- ✿ Instructing the Twelve to continue His ministry after His death, Resurrection, and ascension as His mystical Body, the Church
- ✿ Jesus promises the coming of the Holy Spirit
- ✿ The High Priestly prayer

My Notes

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Review Questions

1. In washing their feet, Jesus prepares His disciples to become priests of the New Covenant. What connection(s) can be drawn to the Levitical priesthood of Old Covenant?
 - a. In the Old Covenant, priests washed their hands and feet to prepare for sacrifice.
 - b. The Levites had the Lord Himself as their portion, rather than an earthly inheritance. The same is true for Jesus' disciples.
 - c. Jesus was showing the disciples the importance of serving oneself first.
 - d. A & B.
2. Which of the following is NOT a component of Jesus' High Priestly prayer (John 17)?
 - a. Jesus prays for the Church
 - b. Jesus prays for those who will not be saved
 - c. Jesus prays for Himself
 - d. Jesus prays for the disciples



Reflection Questions

- 1. In what ways does the account of the “washing the feet” strike you? How do you think it would feel to have Jesus wash your feet?
- 2. What does Jesus’ departure to His Father’s house to prepare a place for us reveal about His identity as Bridegroom of the Church?
- 3. How do the sacraments fulfill Jesus’ promise that the Holy Spirit will come and guide the disciples into all truth?

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Practical Application

This week in your prayer, reflect on the image of Jesus washing His disciples’s feet. Consider the tender love and care He exercised in this action. What acts of compassionate service, seen or unseen, could you do for the people in your day-to-day life? This week, in imitation of Our Lord, practice “washing the feet” of others.

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Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma examines the events of Our Lord’s Passion, focusing especially on Jesus’ identity as both High Priest and Divine Bridegroom.

EPISODE 7

THE CROSS: MARRIAGE BED OF THE MESSIAH

Description

In this penultimate episode, Dr. Bergsma breaks down John's account of Our Lord's Passion, focusing especially on the themes of Jesus as High Priest and Divine Bridegroom. Beginning with Jesus' confrontation with the soldiers in the Garden of Gethsemane, Dr. Bergsma explains the painful contrast John depicts between the illegitimate high priest, Ananias, and the true High Priest, Jesus. In His trials before Ananias and Pontius Pilate, Jesus' words and actions serve to consistently identify Himself as the Messiah. Finally, the "hour" of Our Lord's Passion comes to pass. Jesus' crucifixion has a distinctly nuptial character because He is the Divine Bridegroom of the Church. His death on the cross therefore marks the moment of consummation, of the Lord's total self-gift for His Bride. To conclude this episode, Dr. Bergsma explains how the blood and water which poured forth from Jesus' pierced side is the river of life, which we receive in the sacraments of the holy Catholic Church.

Outline

- ✿ Soldiers arrest Jesus in the Garden
- ✿ Contrast between the illegitimate high priest and Jesus, the true High Priest
- ✿ Peter denies Jesus
- ✿ Pilate condemns Jesus; His crime = He is king of the Jews
- ✿ "Behold your son. Behold your mother."
- ✿ "I thirst:" reveals Jesus' love for us
- ✿ Jesus offers Himself for His Bride
- ✿ Blood and water: the sacraments, a new river of life

1. Why was Jesus crowned with thorns in John 19:2?
 - a. Because thorns are a consequence of sin in the natural world, the crown of thorns reminds us of the sins Jesus bore on the cross.
 - b. Jesus was only crowned with thorns because thorns are sharp and painful.
 - c. Jesus was crowned with thorns because thorns are a sign of our salvation.
2. True or False: In antiquity, the Temple high priest wore a seamless tunic which matched the veil in the holy of holies and represented the cosmos.
 - a. True
 - b. False



Reflection Questions

- 1. As he hung on the cross, Jesus said, “I thirst.” What nuptial dimensions can you draw out from this statement? What do His words tell us about His divine identity?
- 2. On the cross, Jesus gave His mother Mary to the beloved disciple; from that day forth, John took Mary into his home as his own mother. What does this decision reveal about the kind of relationship Jesus desires that each of us have with His Mother?
- 3. In John’s Gospel, we only encounter the Blessed Virgin Mary during the events of Cana and Calvary. Why is this significant? What is Our Lady’s connection to these key events?

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Practical Application

This week, take John 19:26–27 to prayer and reflect on your relationship with Our Lady. Do you invite Mary into your home? Do you allow her to spiritually “mother” you? To grow closer to Mary this week, try adding an extra Marian devotion like the Angelus or Rosary into your daily prayer routine.

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Next Episode

In the final episode of this course, Dr. Bergsma examines the burial of Our Lord and unpacks His Resurrection appearances.

EPISODE 8

THE RESURRECTION: MY LORD AND MY GOD!

Description

In this final episode, Dr. Bergsma traces the events which conclude the Gospel of John, beginning with the burial of Our Lord at the end of John 19. Nicodemus lays Jesus in a virginal tomb, the womb of the Earth. This act recalls the Sacrament of Baptism, wherein we are buried with Christ so that we might be raised to new life in Him. Dr. Bergsma then shifts his attention to Easter Sunday, and the joyous event of Our Lord's Resurrection. He first presents evidence that Our Lord's own graveclothes bear witness to the reality of His Resurrection. Following this, Dr. Bergsma offers a concluding analysis of the seven Resurrection appearances recorded by John. Like Mary, we are called to rejoice in the discovery and embrace of the Divine Bridegroom. Like Thomas, we are called to touch His flesh and blood, to receive Him in the sacraments. And like Peter, we are called to surrender our lives to His all-encompassing love.

Outline

- ✿ Jesus' body is buried within a virginal tomb with myrrh/aloes
- ✿ Peter and John run to the tomb Easter morning
- ✿ Jesus appears to Mary Magdalene
- ✿ Jesus gives the Apostles His Spirit
- ✿ Thomas: "My Lord and my God."
- ✿ Appearance on the shores of Galilee
- ✿ Peter = shepherd of the Church
- ✿ John reveals his authorship

My Notes

Review Questions

1. When Peter and John ran to the tomb, John arrived first but waited for Peter and allowed him to enter first. Why did John do this?
 - a. John was just being polite to Peter because Peter was an older man.
 - b. John had to stop and catch his breath because he was winded.
 - c. Waiting for Peter represents the deference of the mystic to the Magisterium.
 - d. John waited for Peter because he was afraid to enter the tomb on his own.
2. In John 21: 6–11 when the disciples cast their net, they hauled in 153 different fish. What (if any) spiritual significance does this number have?
 - a. At the time, there were 153 known species of fish, so this number symbolizes the universal mission of the Church.
 - b. The number 153 does not have any spiritual significance. John was just trying to paint readers a picture of how full the net was.
 - c. The 153 fish symbolize the 153 different languages that the New Testament would eventually be translated into.



Reflection Questions

- 1. What do you think about the connection Dr. Bergsma drew between the virginal womb of the Blessed Virgin Mary and the virginal tomb in which Our Lord was laid? What aspect(s) of this womb-tomb connection were most striking or surprising to you? Why?
- 2. Read Song of Songs 3:1–5. What parallels can you identify between this “dream sequence” and Jesus’ Resurrection appearance to Mary Magdalene in John 20:11–18? In what ways does the conversation between Jesus and Mary reinforce the Johannine theme of Jesus as Bridegroom?
- 3. In this episode, Dr. Bergsma identifies Thomas’s confession in John 20:24–29 as the climactic moment of John’s Gospel. Do you agree? Why or why not? How might we reflect on the exchange between Thomas and Our Lord as microcosm of the whole Christian life?

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Practical Application

As you finish up this course, return to your reflection from Episode 1. Reread the chapter you chose and reflect on it again. What aspects of John’s literary style and theological focus stand out to you this time? Do you notice anything different from your first time reflecting on this course? How has this course helped you to better understand Scripture?

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REVIEW QUESTIONS ANSWER KEY

Episode 1

1. True
2. B.

Episode 2

1. True
2. False

Episode3

1. D.
2. True

Episode 4

1. True
2. D.

Episode 5

1. B.
2. C.

Episode6

1. D.
2. B.

Episode 7

1. A.
2. True

Episode 8

1. C.
2. A.

NEXT STEPS

Congratulations on completing Dr. John Bergsma's course on the Gospel of John

We hope that this time of study has been fruitful for you, and we wish you every blessing in continuing to grow in your relationship with the Lord. As brothers and sisters in Christ, we are all called to bear authentic witness to the truth and power of the gospel message, so we encourage you to share what you have learned in this course with others.

Encountering the Lord through Sacred Scripture is a lifelong journey, and the St. Paul Center for Biblical Theology wants to support you on your journey. Below you will find a range of resources and materials designed to assist you.

- ✿ Our website, stpaulcenter.com
As a Member of the St. Paul Center, you can access hundreds of hours of video and audio content from trusted theologians. Unfold the riches of Scripture and learn more about your faith with our courses, weekly shows, and insightful podcasts.
- ✿ *The Ignatius Catholic Study Bible: Old and New Testament*
Edited by Dr. Scott Hahn and Curtis Mitch, this unparalleled resource contains nearly 18,000 footnotes, together with maps, charts, and topical essays.
- ✿ *Bible Basics for Catholics* by Dr. John Bergsma
This series from Dr. Bergsma includes a volume introducing the Bible as a whole, volumes focusing specifically on the New Testament and Psalms, and a volume on God's love in the Bible.
- ✿ *Word of the Lord* series by Dr. John Bergsma
This in-depth series is the ideal accompaniment for Catholics looking to go dive deeper into their study of Sacred Scripture, particularly the New Testament.

